Title I, Part A: District grant application assistance

Overview: Over 1,700 districts have successfully purchased Ellevation using federal funding like Title grants. Federal formula or Title grants are non-competitive; each state receives a portion of the funding based on a formula. States, in turn, pass the funding on to local districts and schools.

Federal funding helps supplement multilingual initiatives and can be used towards the purchases of;

Ellevation Platform's English learner (EL) program management
Ellevation Strategies' professional development (PD)

Directions: This document is intended to assist you in applying for Title grants to purchase Ellevation Platform and/or Ellevation Strategies and contains;

Wording that can be directly used in a grant application, which clearly references the relevant Title statutes. Please note: Wording may need to be slightly altered at your discretion depending on your purchase.

Title I Statute Citations inform justification for why a purchase of Ellevation Platform/ Ellevation Strategies is allowable under the Title I.
Sections in bold identify the justification for why a purchase of Ellevation's software is allowable under Title I.

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Wording to use in applications to the state for Title I funds

You can use the below wording when completing an application to the state for Title I, Part A funding to purchase Ellevation Platform and/or Strategies.

Note: You may need to edit out references to either Platform or Strategies if your district only intends to purchase one of them.

Using Title I, Part A funds – Non-School Support and Improvement Funds

Title I funded districts are responsible for accountability for ELs progress toward English language proficiency, and the subgroup of ELs is also separately (disaggregated) for accountability measures (AMD, Sec. 1111(c)(4)(C)(i)) for the other four indicators found in Sec. 1111(c)(4)(B). In addition, Sec. 1112(c)(4) requires that our Title I services are coordinated and integrated with other educational services, including services for ELs. In an effort to meet our accountability obligations and to coordinate and integrate the services we provide to our EL students, our district plans to purchase Ellevation's software.

If purchasing Ellevation Platform include the below:
Our district intends to purchase Ellevation Platform to provide a data analysis platform to help our educators across all schools and programs that serve EL students identify areas of need in our district's English learner program in groups and for individual students to help meet the Title I accountability requirements.

If purchasing Ellevation Strategies include the below:
In addition, our district intends to purchase Ellevation Strategies to provide professional development resources across all schools and programs that serve EL students for our schools, teachers, and other school leaders. Ellevation Strategies professional development is of sufficient intensity and duration to have a positive and lasting impact on student and teacher performance, to help us meet or continue to meet accountability measures across all schools in our district.

Using Title I, Part A – School Support and Improvement Funds

Title I, Sec. 1003(e) indicates that districts are responsible for submitting an application to the State for Support and Improvement funds for their schools identified for Comprehensive and/or Targeted Support and Improvement. Our district has one or more schools identified for School Support and Improvement. In preparation for our application for School Support and Improvement funds, we identified that our EL subgroup is not making progress toward one or more of the accountability indicators identified in Sec. 1111(c)(4)(B) ***[Note: Information describing any indicators where targets weren't met can be added here]***. In addition, Sec. 1112(c)(4) requires that our Title I services are coordinated and integrated with other educational services, including services for ELs. In an effort to meet our accountability obligations, address the needs of EL students in schools identified for School Support and Improvement, and to coordinate and integrate the services we provide to our EL students, our district plans to purchase Ellevation's software.

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If purchasing Ellevation Platform include the below:
In order to address the needs identified, our district intends to purchase Ellevation Platform to provide teachers and leaders with tools to help analyze EL data for assigning the appropriate services available, driving instruction where it is needed for all ELs, groups of ELs, or for each individual EL student.

If purchasing Ellevation Strategies include the below:
Our district also intends to purchase Ellevation Strategies to provide high-quality professional development that is of sufficient intensity and duration to have a positive and lasting impact on student and teacher performance.

Guidance and Regulations

Within-District Allocations Under Title I, Part A of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965 as Amended [by ESSA], Authorized Reservations (page 6) -
AND

> Education Department General Administrative Regulations (EDGAR) 34 CFR 200.77(f) - A district, at its discretion, may reserve funds for "other authorized activities, such as . . . **school improvement, and coordinated services**."

Title I Statute Citations

Title I, Accountability citations:

Sec. 1111(c)(4)(B): This section lists and describes the five indicators that are to be included in a State's Accountability system. *Please note: Other than EL progress toward English proficiency,* ***progress toward long-term goals and interim measures of progress for the other four accountability indicators must be disaggregated for the EL subgroup.***
They include;

1. 1111(c)(4)(B)(i) academic achievement (growth for High Schools at the State's discretion)
2. 1111(c)(4)(B)(ii) growth or another meaningful measure (for non-high schools)
3. 1111(c)(4)(B)(iii) graduation rates (for schools graduating students only)
4. **1111(c)(4)(B)(iv) ELs progress toward English proficiency**
5. 1111(c)(4)(B)(v) school quality or student success indicator (chosen by the state)

Title I, Application and Plan citations:

Sec. 1112(b)(1)(A&D) LEAs' Title I, Part A: This section describes how plans should be designed to close achievement gaps and must describe how the LEA will monitor students' progress in meeting standards by;

- Sec. 1112(b)(1)(A) developing and implementing a well-rounded program of instruction to meet the academic needs of all students
- Sec. 1112(b)(1)(D) **identifying and implementing instructional and other strategies intended to strengthen academic programs** and improve school conditions for student learning

Sec. 1112(b)(2) LEAs' Title I, Part A: Plans should be designed to close achievement gaps and must describe how the LEA will identify and **address disparities that result in low-income and minority students being taught at higher rates than other students by ineffective, inexperienced, or out-of-field teachers.**

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Sec. 1112(b)(5) LEAs' Title I, Part A: Plans should be designed to close achievement gaps and must describe -in general, the nature of the programs to be conducted by the LEAs schools implementing;

- Sec. 1114 *Title I Schoolwide Programs* : Schools operating schoolwide programs must develop a comprehensive plan that;
  - Sec. 1114(b)(6) is based on a comprehensive needs assessment of the entire school that takes into account information on the academic achievement of children in relation to State academic standards, particularly the needs of children who are failing or at-risk of failing.
  - Sec. 1114(b)(7): Schools must develop a schoolwide plan that includes a description of both;
    - Sec. 1114(b)(7)(A) the strategies that the school will be implementing to address school needs, including a **description of how such strategies will (Sec. 1114(b)(7)(A)(i)) provide opportunities for all children, including each subgroup of students [ELs are one of the subgroups]** to meet challenging State academic standards.
    - Sec. 1114(b)(7)(A)(iii) address the needs of **all children** in the school, but **particularly the needs of those at risk of not meeting standards**, through activities which may include:
    - Sec. 1114(b)(7)(A)(iii)(IV) **professional development** and other activities for teachers, paraprofessionals, and other school personnel **to improve instruction and use of data from academic assessments.**

- *Sec. 1115 Title I Targeted Assistance Programs:*
  - Sec. 1115(a): An LEA may use funds in schools operating a Targeted Assistance Program only for programs that provide services to eligible children identified as having the greatest need for special assistance.
  - Sec. 1115(b): Targeted Assistance programs must provide the opportunity to meet State standards by both;
    - Sec. 1115(b)(1) determining which student will be served
    - Sec. 1115(b)(2)(D) programs must serve participating students identified as eligible children, including by - **providing professional development** with resources provided under this part to teachers, principals, other school leaders, paraprofessionals, and, if appropriate, specialized instructional support personnel, and other school personnel who work with eligible children in programs under this section or in the regular education program.

Title 1, Collaboration with other programs (EL programs in particular) citations

- Sec. 1112(a)(1)(B) LEAs **may receive Title I, Part A funds** if they have on file with the State education agency (SEA) a plan approved by the SEA that -as appropriate, is **coordinated with other ESSA programs and other Acts** as appropriate.
- Sec. 1112(c)(4) LEAs must provide an assurance that they will **coordinate and integrate services** provided under this part (Title I, Part A) **with other educational services at the LEA and school level, such as services for ELs** (see 1112(b)(13)).
- Sec. 1112(c)(6) ensure that all teachers and paraprofessionals working in a program supported with (Title I, Part A) funds meet applicable State certification and licensure requirements.

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Title I, School Support and Improvement Funding citations

- Sec. 1003(e) indicates that the LEA must submit an application (not the identified school) to the SEA which shall include at a minimum;
  - Sec. 1003(e)(1) a description of how the LEA will carry out its responsibilities under Sec. 1111(d) (which is the section that describes School Support and Improvement Activities) including how the LEA will--
    - Sec. 1003(e)(1)(A) develop comprehensive support and improvement plans
    - Sec. 1003(e)(1)(B) support schools developing or implementing Targeted Support and Improvement plans

- Sec. 1111(d)(1)(B) LEAs must **develop and implement Comprehensive Support and Improvement Plans** for identified schools that;
  - Sec. 1111(d)(1)(B)(i) **are informed by all indicators in 1111(c)(4)(B)**, including student performance against State-determined long-term goals
  - Sec. 1111(d)(1)(B)(ii) includes evidenced-based interventions
  - Sec. 1111(d)(1)(B)(iii) are based on a school-level needs assessment

- Sec. 1111(c)(4)(D) **Schools are identified for Comprehensive Support and improvement based on the system of meaningful differentiation** described in Sec. 1111(c)(4)(C) (which is the Annual Meaningful Differentiation section) requires that states establish a system of meaningful differentiation which must;
  - Sec. 1111(c)(4)(C)(i) be **based on all indicators in the state's accountability system for all students and for each subgroup of students (AMD must include the EL subgroup for the 4 indicators identified in Sec. 1111(c)(4)(B))**
  - **EL progress toward ELP, which is a separate indicator only for ELs**

- Sec. 1111(d)(2)(A)(i) indicates that **schools are identified for Targeted Support and Improvement based on any subgroups of students identified as consistently underperforming** as described in the AMD section (Sec. 1111(c)(4)(C)(iii)).

- Sec. 1112(b)(3) LEAs' Title I, Part A plans should be designed to close achievement gaps and must describe how the LEA will carry-out its responsibilities under Sec. 1111(d)(1&2), which is the LEAs responsibilities for schools identified for Comprehensive and/or Targeted Support and Improvement.

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